

Visuchika, Alasaka and Vilambhika

Definition of visūcika

It is caused by stretching of walls of hollow viscera, innervated by unmyelinated fibres. It is diffuse and intermittent, dull aching and colicky in nature. Patients keep tossing on the bed. It is felt in the abdominal region which correlates to the somatic segment of embryonic region. Foregut, midgut and hindgut structures relate to upper, middle and lower abdomen, respectively. Visceral pain can be perceived away from actual disease process, i.e. pain of acute appendicitis is felt around umbilicus initially as it corresponds to T10 somatic distribution.

निरुक्ति एवं परिभाषा (Nirukti and Paribhāṣā)

विविधसूचीतुल्यत्वाद्विसूचिका । A.H.Su. 8/7 (Hemādri)

One who experiences different types of pain like pricking, colicky etc is known as *Visūcika*.

विविधानां विकारणां सूचिका-विसूचिकेत्युच्यते ॥

A.H.Su. 8/7 (Aruṇḍatta)

One who experiences varied types of pricking, cramp pain is known as *Visūcika*.

यस्माद्वात्राणि सूचीभिरिव विध्यति, तस्माद्विसूचिकेत्युच्यते ।

A.H.Su. 8/7 (Aruṇḍatta)

Development of pain all over the body like being pricked by needles is known as *Visūcika*.

विशेषण सूचीभिरिव मर्माणि पीडयतीति विसूची ॥

Ādd.Śa.Prā. 7/11

Manifestation of pricking pain in the vital body parts is known as *Visūcika*.

बाहुल्याद्वायुः सूचीभिरिव तुदन् इति विसूचीनिरुक्तिः ॥

M.Ni. 6/16 (Madhu)

Pricking type of pain due to aggravation of *Vāta* is known as *Visūcika*.

विविधैर्वेदनोद्भेदैर्वाय्वादिभूशकोपतः ।

सूचीभिरिव गात्राणि विध्यतीति विसूचिका ॥

A.H.Su. 8/7-8

Aggravation of *Vātadi doṣas* causing different types of pain as though being pricked by needles; therefore it is called as *Visūcika*.

सूचीभिरिव गात्राणि तुदन् सन्तिष्ठतेऽनिलः ।

यस्याजीर्णेन सा वैद्यैरुच्यतेति विसूचिका ॥

S.S.Utt. 56/4

Suffering from pricking pain in the body due to the vitiation of *Vāta* due to indigestion is called *Visūcika* by the physicians.

Definition of Alasaka

It results from irritation of parietal peritoneum caused by inflammation, infection or chemical reaction. It is supplied by myelinated nerve fibres. It is localised and constant. As the disease process evolves and irritates parietal peritoneum, we can elicit tenderness, guarding and rigidity. The patient prefers to lie immobile.

निरुक्ति एवं परिभाषा (Nirukti and Paribhāṣā)

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अलस्त्वं-निष्क्रियत्वम् । A.H.Su. 86 (Hemādri)

The term *Alasa* means *Niṣkriyatva* (inactive).

दोषस्थिरत्वनिमित्तादलसक संज्ञा ॥ Ādd.Śa.Prā. 7/10

अलसक इति दोषस्थिरत्वनिमित्ता संज्ञा ॥

Ma.Ni. 6/19 (Madhu)

Immobile state of abdomen is called as *Alasaka*.

कोष्ठेस्थितोऽलसीभूतस्तेन चालसकः स्मृतः ॥

Ādd.Śa.Prā. 7/10

That which causes ingested food to remain idle in the *Koṣṭha* (stomach) is called *Alasaka*.

प्रयाति नोर्ध्वं नाधस्तादाहरो न च पच्यते ।

आमशयेऽलसीभूतस्तेन सोऽलसकः स्मृतः ॥

A.H.Su. 86/Ma.Ni. 6/19-20 (Madhu)

The condition where the ingested food to remain idle in the stomach without undergoing digestion and either moves upwards (vomiting) nor downwards (purgation) is known as *Alasaka*.

Definition of Vilambikā

This is a kind of indigestion. It occurs due to profound accumulation of *āma* inside the channels. The disease is produced jointly by vitiated *kapha* and *vāta* and has all the symptoms of *āma*. Hence, its treatment is similar to that of *āma*. (AH. Sū. 8. 28).

The place where *āma* gets lodged produce not only pain but also becomes the site for occurrence of several diseases. This situation develops as a result of the action of *doṣa* that travel across the body associated with *āma*. (SS. Ut. 56. 9).

A type of intestinal disorder characterized by stagnation of food ingested. If the ingested food gets vitiated by the aggravated *kapha* and *vāyu*, it moves neither upwards nor downwards. This condition, according to ancient scholars of medicine, is called *vilambikā*. It is extremely difficult to cure. The ingested food, when vitiated by *kapha* and *vāta* does not move upwards or downwards. Such symptoms has been identified as the *Vilambikā* which is very tough to manage according to learned ones.

अजीर्णमामं विष्टब्धं विदग्धञ्च यदीरितम् ।
विमूच्यलसकां तस्माद्भवेच्चापि विलम्बिका ॥

S.S.Utt.56/3

Visūcikā, *Alasaka* & *Vilambikā* manifest due to afflictions of *Āmājīrṇa*, *Viṣṭabdhājīrṇa* & *Vidagdhājīrṇa*.

विसूचिका (Visūcikā)

सूचीभिरिव गात्राणि तुदन् सन्तिष्ठतेऽनिलः ।
यस्याजीर्णेन सा वैद्यैरुच्यतेति विसूचिका ॥
न तां परिमिताहारा लभन्ते विदितागमाः ।
मूढास्तामजितात्मानो लभन्ते कलुषाशयाः ॥

S.S.Utt. 56/4-5

तं द्विविधमामप्रदोषमाचक्षते भिषजः-विसूचिकाम्, अलसकं
चा। तत्र विसूचिकामूर्ध्वं चाधश्च प्रवृत्तामदोषां यथोक्तरूपां विद्यात् ॥

C.S.Vi. 2/10-11

Excessively aggravated *Vāta* consequent to *Ajīrṇa* gives rise to pricking pain in the body is known as *Visūcikā*. One who consumes proper amount of wholesome food and adhering to dietetic rules & regulations will not suffer from *Visūcikā*. It manifest in those individuals who have no control over themselves and indulges in such activities which vitiates the stomach as a result *Visūcikā* manifest.

विसूचिका लक्षण (Visūcikā Lakṣaṇa)

It is characterised by fainting, diarrhoea, vomiting, thirst, abdominal pain, giddiness, rigidity of the extremities, yawning, burning sensation, abnormal complexion, tremors, pain in cardiac region, & headache. *Āmadoṣa* manifest two pathological conditions i.e. *Visūcikā* and *Alasaka*. *Visūcikā* is characterised by expulsion of undigested food from upper channels and lower channels.

अलसक (Alasaka)

कुक्षिरानह्यतेऽत्यर्थं प्रताम्यति विकूजति ।
निरुद्धो मारुतश्चापि कुक्षौ विपरिधावति ॥
वातवर्चोनिरोधश्च कुक्षौ यस्य भृशम्भवेत् ।
तस्यालसकमाचष्टे तृष्णोद्गारावरोधकौ ॥

S.S.Utt. 56/7-8

अलसकमुपदेक्ष्यामदुर्बलस्याल्पाग्नेर्बहुश्लेष्मणो वातमूत्रपुरीष-
वेगविधारिणः स्थिरगुरुबहुक्षशीतशुष्कात्रसेविनस्तदन्न-
पानमनिलप्रपीडितं श्लेष्मणा च विबद्धमार्गमतिमात्रप्रलीन-
मलसत्त्वान्न बर्हिमुखीभवति, ततश्छर्द्यतीसारवज्यान्या-
मप्रदोषलिङ्गान्यभिदर्शयत्यतिमात्राणि। C.S.Vi. 2/12

Severe distension of the abdomen, the patient becomes unconscious and moans, *Vāta* getting obstructed moves upwards in the stomach, there is obstruction to flatus, faeces & accumulation in more quantity inside the abdomen, accompanined with thirst and excessive belchings is known as *Alasaka*.

If debilitated individuals suffering from *Mandāgni* and excessive *Kapha*, suppresses the urge for passing flatus, urine & stool, and consumes compact, heavy, ununctuous, cold & dried food in

excess; get pressed by *Vāta* and their passage being obstructed by *Kapha*. Because of the sluggishness caused by these factors it is not possible for the undigested food product to come out; then they exhibit excessively the symptom of over affliction of *Āma* except vomiting

दण्डालसक (Daṇḍālasaka)

अतिमात्रप्रदुष्टाश्च दोषाः प्रदुष्टामबद्धमार्गास्तिर्यग्गच्छन्तः कदाचिदेव केवलमस्य शरीरं दण्डवत् स्तम्भ्यन्ति, ततस्तं दण्डालसकमसाध्यं बुवते । C.S.Vi. 2/12

Excessively aggravated and vitiated *Doṣās* moves obliquely, when their passage is blocked by over vitiated *Āma* and make the body of the patient rigid like a stiff is known as *Daṇḍālasaka*.

आमविष (Āmaviṣa)

Described in first volume of my book under *Āma* chapter.

विलम्बिका (Vilambikā)

दुष्टन्तु भुक्तं कफमारुताभ्यां प्रवर्तते नोर्ध्वमधश्च यस्य । विलम्बिकां तां भृशदुश्चिकित्सामाचक्षते शास्त्रविदः पुराणाः ॥ S.S.Utt. 56/9

Food getting vitiated by *Kapha* & *Vāta*, does not come out either from downward or from upward channels and waste products remain for longer period of time in the *Mahāsrotas* is known as *Vilambikā* and which is difficult to treat.

Signs and symptoms after consumption of in improper quantity of food

अमात्रावत्त्वं पुनर्द्विविधमाचक्षतेहीनम्, अधिकं च । तत्र हीनमात्रमाहारराशिं बलवर्णोपचयक्षयकरमत्पिकरमुदावर्त-करमनायुष्यवृष्यमनौजस्यं शरीरमनोबुद्धीन्द्रियोपघातकरं सारविधमनम-लक्ष्यावहमशीतेश्च वातविकाराणामायतनपाचक्षते, अतिमात्रं पुनः सर्वदोषप्रकोपणमिच्छन्ति कुशलाः । यो हि मूर्तानामाहारजातानां सौहित्यं गत्वा द्रवैस्तृप्तिमापद्यते भूयस्तस्यामाशयगता वातपित्तश्लेष्माणोऽभ्यवहारेणातिमात्रेणाति-प्रपीड्यमानाः सर्वे युगपत् प्रकोपमापद्यन्ते, ते प्रकुपितास्तमेवाहार-राशिमपरिणतमाविश्य कुक्ष्येकदेशमन्नाश्रिता विष्टम्भयन्तः सहसा वाऽप्युत्तराधराभ्यां मार्गाभ्यां प्रच्यावयन्तः पृथक् पृथागिमान् विकारानभिनिर्वर्तयन्त्यतिमात्रभोक्तुः तत्र वातः शूलानाहाङ्ग-मर्दमुखशोष मूर्च्छाभ्रमाग्निवैषम्यापार्श्वपृष्ठकटिग्रहसिराकुञ्चन-

स्तम्भनानि करोति, पित्तं पुनर्ज्वातीसारान्तर्दाहं तृष्णामदभ्रम-प्रलपनानि, श्लेष्मा तु छर्द्यरोचकाविपाकशीतज्वरालस्यगात्र-गौरवाणि ॥ C.S.Vi. 2/7

Improper quantity of food is subdivided into two types namely deficient and excess.

Deficient quantity of food produces following signs & symptoms are as follows : Loss of strength, complexion & development; emaciation; unsaturation; upward movement of *Vāta*; diminished longevity, virility and ojas (immunity); damage to body, mind, intellect and senses; impairment of *Sāra*; development of inauspicious conditions and causative factor for eighty types of *Vātaja Vikara*.

Effect of excess quantity of food

Excessively consumed food aggravates all the three *Doṣās*. One who consumes solid food in sufficient quantity and then takes liquid food in excessive quantity, all the three *Doṣās* get too much compressed and simultaneously aggravated. These exacerbated *Doṣās* enters into the undigested food situated in a portion of belly and cause distension of abdomen or instantaneously moves through upward & down tracts separately to produce following signs and symptoms-

Vāta produces colic pain; constipation; malaise; dryness of mouth; fainting; giddiness; irregular digestion; stiffness in sides of chest, back and waist; constriction & hardening of blood vessels. *Pitta* produces fever, diarrhoea, internal burning sensation, thirst, intoxication, giddiness & delirium. *Kapha* produces vomiting, anorexia, indigestion, fever with cold, lassitude & heaviness of body.

MCQs

1. *Dosha* predominance of *Vilambhika*
 - a. *Vatika*
 - b. *Vatakapahaja*
 - c. *Vatapittaja*
 - d. *Tridoshaja*
2. Prognosis of *Vilambhika*
 - a. *Asadya*
 - b. *Kashtasadya*
 - c. *Brisaduschikitsya*
 - d. *Yapya*
3. *Vishuchika upadrava*

- a. *Nidranasa, Arati & Mutraghata*
 b. *Nidra, Glani, ati pravritti of mutra*
 c. *Tama, tandra & glani*
 d. *Murchha, tandra, glani*
4. *Kukshirana hyatheatyartham* is the feature of
 a. *Alasaka* b. *Amaajeerna*
 c. *Vilambika* d. *Gulma*
5. Number of *Vishuchika upadrava* as per *Madavanidana*
 a. 4 b. 5
 c. 6 d. 7
6. Which among the following is not the *Asadyalakshana* of *Vishuchika & Alasaka*
 a. *Syavadanta & oshta*
 b. *Abhyantaraayatanetra*
 c. *Kshamaswara*
 d. *Vishamajwara*
7. *Suchibhirivagatranitudyen* is the feature of
 a. *Vilambika* b. *Gulma*
 c. *Vishuchika* d. *Sula*
8. Which among the following is not the *lakshana* of *Alasaka*
 a. *Vatavarchonirodha*
 b. *Trishna*
 c. *Udgara*
 d. *Na pravarthateurdhwamadhascha*
9. *Kampa* and *hridayaruja* seen in
 a. *Vatajaajeerna* b. *Vishuchika*
 c. *Anaha* d. *Vilambhika*

Answer

1. b	2. c	3. a
4. a	5. b	6. d
7. c	8. d	9. b